ARAVIND NATARAJAN

Engineering & Delivery Operations Manager | *Release & Incident Governance* | *Cross-Functional Delivery*
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quality and delivery leader with nearly a decade across **Amazon**, **Brightcove** and a **0-to-1 mandate** at a Series A grocery-delivery platform that raised $11M+. Turns ambiguous, fast-moving operations into **governed, predictable delivery** that leadership can plan around. As QA Manager, owned **release go/no-go, incident governance and PRD reviews** for a 35-person tech org, shipping **150+ releases** on a predictable cadence and cutting SOS escalations by **~80%**.

DELIVERY IMPACT AT A GLANCE

Daily hotfixes to a predictable release cadence | **~80% fewer** SOS escalations | **75%+ to under 20%** defect leakage
30+ initiatives shipped | **50+** projects delivered | **$69K+** cumulative annual savings

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BUNCHA | Remote | May 2025 – Sep 2026

Quality Assurance Manager (QA, Release & Operations)

US-based grocery delivery platform (Series A, $11M+ raised)

- **Owned release go/no-go** with mandatory signed release gates, moving a startup from daily hotfixes to a predictable cadence (weekly, evolving to bi-weekly major releases with mid-week patches) across 150+ releases; defect leakage fell from 75%+ to under 20% and app crashes 85%.
- **Built company-wide release and team tracking from scratch**, refined over months of observation into weekly leadership reporting on release readiness, sign-offs, late changes, capacity and incidents (demo-data version in portfolio).
- **Reported to the Head of Product and later the CEO, with a standing seat on the executive release-priority panel**; owned company-wide PRD reviews, triggering a full PRD rewrite for a major release and catching conflicting capacity-check and ETA-routing logic before development.
- **Authored the incident-severity framework and escalation matrix** adopted by Support, SRE and Engineering and secured a dedicated after-hours SRE hire; **SOS escalations fell ~80%**, from 4–6 a week to 3–4 a month.
- **Led end-to-end delivery for the Meijer launch** (3 stores at launch, 13 today; 1-hour delivery, ~370 daily orders, $5,000+ daily revenue) and a self-serve shopping-to-delivery flow that reclaimed ~4 hours a week and ended after-hours escalations.
- **Drove release quality across 30+ initiatives**, including marketplace expansion, dynamic ETAs, delivery integrations (DoorDash, Uber, Onfleet), customer communications (Twilio, TalkJS), dispatcher automation and workforce systems (Branch 1099 payments, shift acceptance, geofenced attendance).
- **Ran a daily RCA process** routing customer issues straight into the engineering queue for same-day fixes; served as company-wide first contact for production issues and onboarded every new operations and engineering hire.
- **Built and led a 4-person QA team, including a QA Lead,** in a 35-person tech org (12–16 developers): hiring, KPIs, reviews and growth plans, running daily standups, sprint estimation and retrospectives for QA, and facilitating company-wide weekly sprint ceremonies on a rotation, through an unbacked headcount reduction.

  AI-assisted tools built (1,300+ engineering hours and $14,800 reclaimed a year):

  - **Bytecast** (live on the Chrome Web Store): Claude-powered extension that files complete bug reports (video, logs, network, steps) into Jira, ClickUp and 8 other trackers in one click.
  - **FlowForge** (built with AI): Android app that records user flows and generates pytest + Appium 2 Page Object scripts, with GitHub PR export and AI review of flaky locators and missing assertions.
  - **Test-order admin tool**: admin UI pulling live production and Elasticsearch data to create test orders in under 1 min (from ~18), removing a ~$30 per-order cost; adopted company-wide for in-store trials and extended into Greenhouse onboarding.
  - **Unified alerting platform**: co-built with SRE a single view of New Relic, Datadog, Redis and RabbitMQ alerts across environments, exposing two runaway services and eliminating ~100K redundant daily service calls.

BRIGHTCOVE | Chennai, India | Dec 2021 – Mar 2025

Quality Assurance Engineer (APAC QA Lead)

Global video and OTT streaming platform

- **Owned APAC delivery quality as a founding member of Brightcove's India professional services team** and the region's only QA engineer, **led and mentored 4 contractors** beyond formal scope, across 10 enterprise accounts (Spotify, AT&T, BBC, Cisco, Dell, ExxonMobil, GM), delivering **50+ projects, including 5 large enterprise launches**, and using go/no-go authority to hold back releases that were not ready.
- **Saved $40,000+ a year** in rework and support costs through standardized pre-production gates and a root-cause and triage process that cut recurring issues by over half.
- **Cut production rollbacks by over half and raised CSAT 20%** through tighter release planning and earlier defect detection; recognized by the Director, a Senior VP and multiple clients.
- Owned testing across web, mobile, Android TV and admin consoles, plus data-integrity validation on customer migrations; cut regression time from 10h to 4h per cycle.

AMAZON | Chennai, India | Dec 2019 – Dec 2021

Sr. Associate, Quality Service

- **Led a team of 10+** across 6 concurrent projects and 28+ features, partnering daily with US leadership, developers and TPMs across a full time-zone gap.
- **Cut new-hire onboarding from 9 weeks to under 4**, lifting team efficiency 30%.
- **Zero launch-blocking auth defects** across 18 locales and 20+ device types as a founding member of Alexa Identity launch operations; owned Alexa Presence testing with the Seattle development team.
- **Saved $15,000+ a year** by cutting the regression suite from 1,100 to 180 cases, and automated reporting (2h to 20 min daily, 400+ hours a year).
- **Held invalid defects under 1%** and cut resolution time 20% by rewriting defect-reporting standards.

AMAZON | Chennai, India | Jun 2017 – Dec 2019

Associate, Quality Service

- **Prevented critical launch blockers** by streamlining weekly regression for the Alexa mobile app across Android, iOS and Fire Tablets.
- Grew ownership of one app area into **full end-to-end Alexa Identity validation**.
- Earned **9 company awards in 2.5 years** (including Star of the Month and Quarterback Champion) and a fast-track promotion to Sr. Associate.

CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Delivery & Release Management:** Release Go/No-Go & Readiness Reviews, Release Gates & Sign-offs, Release Planning, Project & Program Management, Effort Estimation, Weekly Prioritization, PRD Review, Roadmap Alignment, Capacity Planning, SDLC & STLC
- **Operations & Incident Governance:** Incident Severity Frameworks (P0–P3), Escalation Matrices & Response SLAs, Daily RCA, Production Issue Triage, Customer-Issue Ownership, Cross-functional Coordination
- **People & Stakeholders:** Hiring & Interviewing (40+ candidates), Onboarding, KPIs, Performance Reviews, Mentoring; Contractor & Vendor Management; Executive & Cross-functional Stakeholder Management
- **Reporting & Tracking:** KPI Dashboards, Weekly Leadership Reporting, Quality & Delivery Metrics (defect leakage/escape rate, defect removal efficiency, invalid-defect rate, MTTR, bug SLA, regression cycle time), Excel (pivot tables, advanced formulas, dashboards), Power BI, Jira (JQL, dashboards, automation rules), ClickUp, Confluence, Metabase, SQL, Datadog, New Relic (NRQL)
- **Process & Quality:** Process Improvement, Root Cause Analysis, Risk-Based Testing, UAT, Agile & Scrum (sprint planning, estimation, daily standups, retrospectives), Kanban (ClickUp boards, WIP tracking), Six Sigma Yellow Belt
- **Technical Fluency:** Team-wide Claude rollout, Claude API, Claude Code, MCP, Prompt Engineering, LLM evaluation, Workflow automation (Zapier, Jira automation), Selenium, Postman, JMeter, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions), AI-generated test scripts (FlowForge), Redis, RabbitMQ, Elasticsearch

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Electronics and Communication Engineering | Sri Krishna College of Engineering and Technology | CGPA 8.13

- Six Sigma Yellow Belt Certified
- Anthropic Academy: Claude API, Model Context Protocol, Claude Code and Agent Skills (2026)
- ISTQB Foundation Level (CTFL): in progress, exam planned Jan 2027